PERSEPOLIS

Details **Originally published** Persepolis: The Story Of A Childhood (2003); Persepolis: The Story Of A Return (2004) **Publisher** L'Association (France)/Jonathan Cape (UK)/Pantheon Books (US) **Writer** Marjane Satrapi **Artist** Marjane Satrapi **Collected in** Persepolis I and II **Available digitally** Random House

Writer and artist Marjane Satrapi's *Persepolis* is one of the definitive examples of the graphic memoir format.

Satrapi applies her irrepressible voice and richly expressive art style to her experiences of growing up in Iran during the Islamic Revolution, living in Vienna, and returning to her homeland, with romance, sex, divorce and discovery along the way.

Along with her strong-minded mother and grandmother, Satrapi is a dissenter and independent thinker from a young age, defying the stereotype of Muslim women as subservient or repressed.

Persepolis's take on how the political affects the personal is heartbreaking – women almost coming to blows over groceries during a food shortage – and hilarious: young Marjane claiming a photo of Michael Jackson on her jacket depicts Malcolm X, or a drawing class where female subjects wear head-to-toe veils.

It's an honest, complex, painful and beautiful book that deserves not just to be read, but to be treasured. Just as the cover reviews states, it will be a read that stays with you long after you turn over the last page.







